

The 35/45 Turkic Window

Gateway to the Muslim World?



Notes: Town and people locations are approximate. Peoples markings indicate significant Turkic populations and do not necessarily represent all turkic peoples.

Turkish · Azerbaijani · Gahauz · Crimean Tartar · Turkmen · Kazak · Kirghiz · Uzbek · Uyghur

The *Red Line* indicates the ancient Great Silk Route

The Silk Road – the great highway that shaped history – draws a band across the heart of the modern Turkic World. Ninety percent of the world's 142 million Turkic speakers live along its course, between the 35th and 45th parallels. Turkic speakers are the majority in countries stretching from Turkey through Central Asia to northwestern China. They share four great things in common: a common homeland, the Silk Road; a common culture, Turkic; a common heritage, the boiling cauldron of Central Asia; a common vision, the 35/45 Turkic Window for Christ.

The land now known as Central Asia, which lies at the heart of the Silk Road, was once called Turkestan. Marco Polo, the first European to travel the length of the Silk Road, called it the Province of Greater Turkey. When Russia and China split Central Asia in two, the western half became Russian Turkestan, and the eastern part Chinese Turkestan. Until recently, most of the Turkic peoples living between Turkey and eastern Turkestan called themselves Turkestanis or Turkis. These are the peoples calling out to us from the 35/45 Turkic Window.

A common Turkic identity as a political agenda is not shared by all the Turkic peoples of the Turkic Window. In the wake of the Cold War, Islam uses Turkic affinities of language and culture as a unifying force. While recognizing the Turkic cultural affinity, Christians should also be sensitive to ethnic identities. Azeris and Turks are different from each other, and Uzbeks and Uyghurs are distinct, despite their similarities. Greater than the need for a national identity, however, is the common spiritual need for salvation. Today, God is working in a fresh and powerful way among all the Turkic peoples of the 35/45 Turkic Window.

When we focus prayer and partnerships on the 35/45 Turkic Window, we are asking God to impact all the Turkic and non-Turkic peoples who live along the old Silk Road. We also are asking God's people worldwide to pray and participate with the Holy Spirit's call to go into the 35/45 Turkic Window. As you learn about this region, ask God three questions: How can I pray? Where can I go? What can I do?

In the Turkic Window there may be lots of old, crumbling buildings, muddy streets and messed up lives. But is also there something beautiful: the fragrance of Christ in the lives of new believers."

As a Turkic beliver so eloquently put it: "The Turkic World is the gateway to the most resistant peoples on earth. But Jesus has opened a door that no man can shut. It's time to call on God's people to step through that door with their prayer and with their professions, empowering those within to reach their world for Him."

Church, lets move through the 35/45 Turkic Window, gateway to the Muslim world?

Cluster	People Name	Country Name	1998 Population	1990 # Evang.	1999 # Evang.	# AAG
Azerbaijani						
Azerbaijani	Qizilbash (Afshari, Shia)	Afghanistan	10,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani (Azeri Turk)	Armenia	161,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani (Azeri)	Armenia	89,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani (Azeri Turk)	Azerbaijan	6,069,000	5	2,250	
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani (Azeri Turk)	Georgia	650,000			
Azerbaijani	Afshari	Iran	290,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani (Azeri)	Iran	22,000,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani (Azeri)	Iraq	300,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani	Kazakstan	90,000		50	
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani	Kyrgyzstan	17,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani	Kyrgyzstan	16,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani	Russia	336,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani	Turkey	530,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani	Turkmenistan	33,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani	Turkmenistan	35,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani	Ukraine	34,000			
Azerbaijani	Azerbaijani	Uzbekistan	38,000			
Totals			30,678,000	5	2,300	97.6%
Gagauz						
Gagauz	Gagauz (Caganzi Turk)	Moldova	173,000	1,000	10,000	
Gagauz	Balkan Gagauzi Turk	Bulgaria	14,000			
Gagauz	Yoruk (Anatolian Gagauz)	Turkey	327,000		5	
Totals			514,000	1,000	10,005	29.2%

Cluster	People Name	Country Name	1998 Population	1990 # Evang.	1999 # Evang.	# AAG
Kazak						
Kazak	Kazak	China	1,112,000		20	
Kazak	Karakalpak	Iran	36,000			
Kazak	Kazak	Kazakstan	8,100,000	20	5,000	
Kazak	Kazak	Kyrgyzstan	39,000		3	
Kazak	Kazak (Qazaq)	Mongolia	100,000		20	
Kazak	Kazak	Russia	600,000		100	
Kazak	Kazak	Tajikistan	12,000			
Kazak	Karakalpak	Turkey	62,000			
Kazak	Kazak	Turkey	20,000		5	
Kazak	Kazak	Turkmenistan	92,000			
Kazak	Kazak	Ukraine	11,000			
Kazak	Karakalpak	Uzbekistan	409,000		400	
Kazak	Kazak	Uzbekistan	845,000		1,800	
Totals			11438000	20	7348	92.8%
Kirghiz						
Kirghiz	Kirghiz	China	150,000		5	
Kirghiz	Kirghiz	Kazakstan	15,000			
Kirghiz	Kirghiz	Kyrgyzstan	2,781,000	5	1,500	
Kirghiz	Kirghiz	Russia	43,000			
Kirghiz	Kirghiz	Tajikistan	67,000		5	
Kirghiz	Kirghiz	Uzbekistan	183,000		5	
Totals			3239000	5	1515	88.7%
Other						
Other	Khalaj	Iran	17,000			
Other	Bashkir	Kazakstan	21,400			
Other	Altai	Russia	71,600			
Other	Balkar	Russia	85,000			
Other	Bashkir	Russia	1,406,000		100	
Other	Chulym (Melets Tatar)	Russia	12,000			
Other	Chuvash	Russia	1,800,000	5		
Other	Karachay (Alan)	Russia	156,000			
Other	Kumyk (Kumuk, Khasavi)	Russia	282,000			

Cluster	People Name	Country Name	1998 Population	1990 # Evang.	1999 # Evang.	# AAG
Other	Bashkir	Uzbekistan	20,800			
Totals			3,871,800	5	100	39.5%
Qashqai						
Qashqai	Qashqai (Kashkai)	Iran	850,000	0	1	
Totals			850,000	0	1	
Tatar						
Tatar	Tatar	Azerbaijan	29,000			
Tatar	Tatar	Belarus	15,000		10	
Tatar	Tatar	Kazakstan	343,000		310	
Tatar	Tatar	Kyrgyzstan	73,000		30	
Tatar	Crimean Tatar	Romania	25,000			
Tatar	Nogay Tatar (Nogai)	Romania	11,000			
Tatar	Crimean Tatar	Russia	26,000			
Tatar	Khakass, Sagai	Russia	57,000			
Tatar	Nogay Tatar (Nogai)	Russia	67,500			
Tatar	Tatar (Kazan Tatar)	Russia	5,715,000	25	2,000	
Tatar	Tatar	Tajikistan	75,000			
Tatar	Crimean Tatar	Turkey	22,000			
Tatar	Tatar (Tartar)	Turkey	21,000			
Tatar	Tatar	Turkmenistan	41,000			
Tatar	Crimean Tatar	Ukraine	250,000		30	
Tatar	Crimean Tatar	Uzbekistan	268,800		490	
Tatar	Tatar	Uzbekistan	489,000			
Totals			7,526,300	25	2,870	69.4%
Turkish						
Turkish	Turk	Australia	36,000		10	
Turkish	Turk	Austria	23,000			
Turkish	Turk	Azerbaijan	19,000			
Turkish	Turk	Belgium	51,000			
Turkish	Rumelian Turk	Bosnia-Hercegovina	50,000			
Turkish	Millet	Bulgaria	500,000	200	15,000	
Turkish	Rumelian Turk	Bulgaria	789,000			
Turkish	Turk	France	214,000			

Cluster	People Name	Country Name	1998 Population	1990 # Evang.	1999 # Evang.	# AAG
Turkish	Turk	Germany	1,200,000		100	
Turkish	Rumelian Turk	Greece	180,000			
Turkish	Khorasani Turk	Iran	400,000			
Turkish	Anatolian Turk	Iraq	22,000			
Turkish	Meskhetian Turk	Kazakstan	125,000			
Turkish	Turk	Kyrgyzstan	22,000			
Turkish	Rumelian Turk	Macedonia	250,000			
Turkish	Tuvin (Tuva, Tuwa)	Mongolia	27,000			
Turkish	Nogay (Nogai)	Romania	11,000			
Turkish	Rumelian Turk	Romania	14,000			
Turkish	Khakas, Sagai	Russia	64,000			
Turkish	Nogay (Nogai)	Russia	75,000		50	
Turkish	Turk	Russia	10,000			
Turkish	Tuvin (Tuva, Tuwa)	Russia	206,000	0	50	
Turkish	Yakut	Russia	400,000		200	
Turkish	Turk	Saudi Arabia	17,000			
Turkish	Turk	Switzerland	13,000			
Turkish	Turk	Syria	45,000			
Turkish	Turk, Turkish Speaking	Turkey	46,278,000	261	1,120	
Turkish	Meskhetian Turk	Uzbekistan	37,000			
Totals			51,078,000	461	16,530	48.8%
Turkmen						
Turkmen	Turkmen (Turkoman)	Afghanistan	380,000			
Turkmen	Turkmen (Turkomani)	Iran	1,000,000			
Turkmen	Turkmen (Turkoman)	Pakistan	10,000			
Turkmen	Turkmen (Turkoman)	Russia	41,000			
Turkmen	Turkmen (Turkoman)	Syria	98,000			
Turkmen	Turkmen (Turkoman)	Tajikistan	14,000			
Turkmen	Turkmen (Turkoman)	Turkmenistan	2,918,000	5	500	
Turkmen	Turkmen (Turkoman)	Uzbekistan	131,000			
Totals			4,592,000	5	500	66.8%

Cluster	People Name	Country Name	1998 Population	1990 # Evang.	1999 # Evang.	# AAG
Uyghur						
Uyghur	Uighur	China	8,100,000	10	50	
Uyghur	Uighur	Kazakstan	350,000	0	350	
Uyghur	Uighur	Kyrgyzstan	43,000	0	50	
Uyghur	Uighur	Uzbekistan	37,000	0	0	
Totals			8,550,000	10	450	52.6%
Uzbek						
Uzbek	Uzbek	Afghanistan	1,403,000			
Uzbek	Uzbek	China	15,000			
Uzbek	Uzbek	Kazakstan	346,000		200	
Uzbek	Uzbek	Kyrgyzstan	575,000			
Uzbek	Uzbek	Mongolia	20,000			
Uzbek	Uzbek	Pakistan	56,000			
Uzbek	Uzbek	Russia	133,000			
Uzbek	Uzbek, Northern	Tajikistan	1,252,000			
Uzbek	Uzbek	Turkmenistan	331,000			
Uzbek	Uzbek	Ukraine	21,000			
Uzbek	Uzbek, Northern	Uzbekistan	16,539,000	5	800	
Totals			20,691,000	5	1,000	80.2%
Totals						
Segment						
All Turkic World			143,008,100	1,541	42,619	44.6%
Turkey			47,260,000	261	1,130	17.7%
Rest of Turkic World			95,748,100	1,280	41,489	47.2%

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